

Jeremy Springman, PhD

Research Scientist, Meta

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🌐: <https://github.com/jrspringman>

I am an applied researcher with deep experience leading large-scale research projects focused on political dynamics in conflict-affected countries and U.S. foreign policy amidst heightened geopolitical competition. I have deep experience establishing long-term collaborations with public and private sector partners and communicating technical material to policy audiences. I have six years of experience managing a team of 12 researchers and staff in a lab environment and 10 years of experience with cutting-edge social science research tools. Since 2022, I have been awarded \$3.5 million as a principal investigator on both federal and private grants.

Academic & Industry Appointments

Meta, Demography & Survey Science (DSS)

Research Scientist and AI Captain

July 2025 – Present

University of Pennsylvania, PDRI-DevLab

Non-Resident Scholar

July 2025 – Present

Research Assistant Professor

July 2024 – July 2025

Senior Research Associate & Director of Research

July 2022 – June 2024

Duke University, DevLab@Duke

Senior Research Associate

July 2021 – June 2022

Post-Doctoral Research Associate

July 2019 – June 2021

Pre-Doctoral Research Associate

January 2019 – July 2019

Education

University of Pennsylvania

Ph.D. in Comparative Politics & International Relations

2019

M.A. in Political Science

2015

University of Pittsburgh

B.A. in Politics & Philosophy (Honors College)

2012

Refereed Academic Publications

The Political Economy of NGO Service Provision: Evidence from an Ancillary Field Experiment
World Politics, 2022 (DOI: S0043887122000107)

The Effect of Government Repression on Civil Society: Evidence from Cambodia

International Studies Quarterly, 2022 (DOI: sqac028)

First author (with Edmund Malesky, Lucy Right, and Erik Wibbels)

Oil Discoveries and Political Windfalls: Evidence on Presidential Support in Uganda

Political Science Research & Methods, 2023 (DOI: psrm.2023.14)

Second author (with Laura Paler, Guy Grossman, and Jan Pierskalla)

Pushing Back or Backing Down? Evidence on Donor Responses to Restrictive NGO Legislation

International Organization, 2025

First author (with Lucy Right and Erik Wibbels)

Two Dilemmas in the Politics of Ethnic Federalism: Experimental Evidence from Ethiopia

Journal of Conflict Resolution, Online First (February 2026) (DOI: 10.1177/00220027261427753)

Second author (with Braeden Davis, David Dow, and Juan Tellez)

Under Review

New Approaches to Forecasting Civil Violence and Geopolitical Crises

with Mahda Soltani and Erik Wibbels

Fostering Civic Engagement in Polarized, Autocratic Regimes: Evidence from a Field Experiment in Ethiopia

with Sewareg Adamu, David Dow, Fitsum Hailu, Mesele Mengsteab, and Juan Tellez

The Effect of Government Intervention on the Operational Decisions of NGOs: Evidence from a Survey Experiment in Three Electoral Autocracies

with Erik Wibbels, Maria Nagawa, Graeme Robertson, and Simon Hollerbauer

Foreign Influence by Authoritarian Governments: Introducing New Data and Evidence

with Fatih Serkant Adiguzel, Mateo Villamizar Chaparro, Zung-Ru Lin, Donald Moratz, Diego Romero, and Erik Wibbels

Aid Flows and Incumbency Advantage: Evidence from NGO Projects in Uganda

Selected Policy Reports

High Frequency Tracking of Civic Space Utilizing Domestic News Scraping and Large Language Model Classification

Prepared for Swift Expertise and Grounded Analytics Task Order by USAID DRG Bureau
November 2024

Forecasting High-Level Travel Advisories with Machine Learning for Peace Data

Prepared for Swift Expertise and Grounded Analytics Task Order by USAID DRG Bureau
November 2024

Zimbabwe Governance Indicators Analysis

Prepared for USAID Zimbabwe
March 2024

Resurgent Authoritarian Influence: Evidence from Machine-Generated, Cross-National Data

Prepared for USAID Analytic Task on Authoritarian Resurgence and Influence
August 2023

Radio and Social Media in Ghana Assessment Report

Prepared for USAID Ghana
July 2023 (DEC ID: coming soon)

The Effect of Social Ties on Engagement & Cohesion: Evidence from Ethiopian University Students

Prepared for USAID Innovation, Technology, & Research Hub
April 2023 (DEC ID: PA-021155)

Resiliency Cambodia Impact Evaluation Findings Report

Prepared for USAID Cambodia

August 2022 (DEC ID: PA-00Z-KBD)

Retrospective of USAID’s Response to Pandemic-Enabled Democratic Backsliding

Prepared for USAID Democracy, Human Rights, and Governance Center

January 2022 (DEC ID: PA-00Z-6HN)

Policy Writing

Charting a Course for Applied Research in Peacebuilding

First author (with Heather Huntington and Erik Wibbels)

Forthcoming in “A Positive Peace: Towards an Evidence-Based Peacebuilding” (United States Institute of Peace)

Report of the Advisory Panel for the Governance of Human Rights Organizations

With Mohamed Arafa and David Siegel (convened by Dr. Hazar Yueksel for Amnesty International) SocArXiv DOI: 10.31235

Selected External Awards & Grants

United States Department of Defense Minerva Research Initiative

Modeling Climate-Induced Societal Adaptation and Population Displacement with New Machine-Coded Environmental Event Data: \$1,600,000 *with Erik Wibbels and Iriana Marinov*

Open Society Foundations

Special Projects & Crisis Response: \$250,000* *with Erik Wibbels*

USAID Democracy, Human Rights, and Governance Bureau

- Tracking Authoritarian Resurgence and Democratic Institutions and Spaces: \$890,000*
- Distinguishing Legitimate, Superficial, and Fabricated Anti-corruption Campaigns: \$46,690
- Central American Regional Media Project Impact Evaluation: \$75,554 (Phase 1-2)
- Zimbabwe Governance Indicators Analysis: \$37,894
- Swift Expertise and Grounded Analytics: \$500,000*
- Analytic Task on Authoritarian Resurgence and Influence: \$99,737*
- INSPIRES Flexible Response Funds: \$83,000*

United States Agency for International Development (USAID) Bureau for Policy, Planning, and Learning

Local Evaluation and Evidence Support (LEES): \$98,060

University of Antwerp

Foreign Information Manipulation and Interference: \$12,500*

USAID Ghana Monitoring Evaluation and Learning (MEL) Platform

Radio Station Managers Survey: \$30,000*

USAID Innovation, Technology, and Research Hub

LASER PULSE (with Mesele Mengsteab, Juan Tellez, and David Dow): \$250,000

USAID Mission to Cambodia

Local Organizations—Movement Towards Self-Reliance: \$225,000*